

# ENME601 Thermodynamics

Week 6 – The Second Law of Thermodynamics

Presenter: Dr. Jay Wang

# Objectives

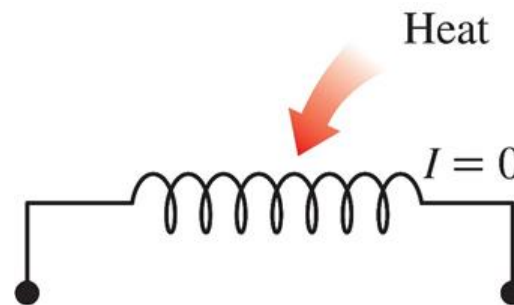
- Introduce the **second law of thermodynamics**.
- Discuss **thermal energy reservoirs, heat engines, refrigerators, and heat pumps** and their thermal efficiencies and coefficients of performance.
- Describe the **Kelvin–Planck** and **Clausius statements** of the second law of thermodynamics.
- Discuss **reversible and irreversible processes**.
- Describe the **Carnot cycle** and examine the **Carnot principles**, idealized Carnot heat engines, refrigerators, and heat pumps.
- Determine the expressions for the **thermal efficiencies** and **coefficients of performance** for **reversible heat engines, heat pumps, and refrigerators**.

# Introduction

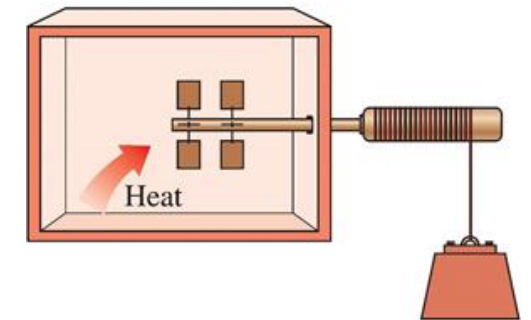
- The first Law requires that **energy be conserved during a process**. The Second Law of Thermodynamics goes further and asserts that **processes involving energy changes occur in a certain direction** and that **energy has quality as well as quantity**.
- A process cannot take place unless it **satisfies both the first law and the second law of thermodynamics**.
- These processes are okay according to the first law but violate the second law.



**Figure 7–1:** A cup of hot coffee does not get hotter in a cooler room.



**Figure 7–2:** Transferring heat to a wire will not generate electricity.

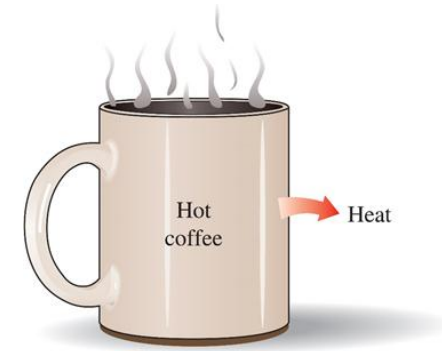


**Figure 7–3:** Transferring heat to a paddle wheel will not cause it to rotate.

# Introduction

## Major uses of the second law.

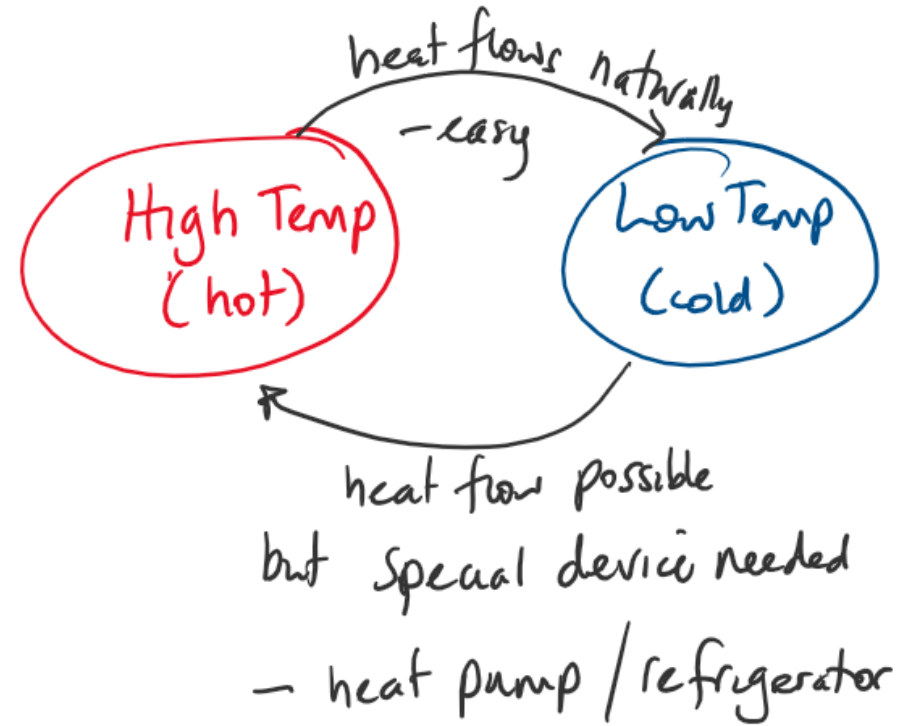
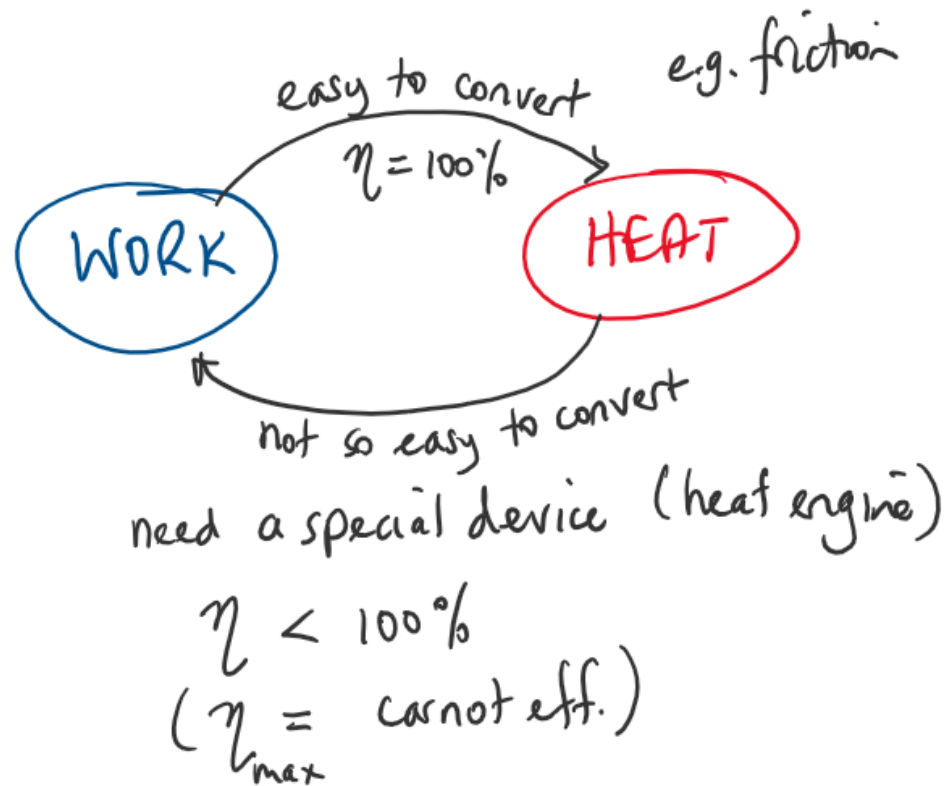
- The second law may be used to **identify the direction of processes**.
- The second law asserts **that energy has quality as well as quantity**. For example, we will find that work is a better form of energy flow than heat.
- The second law of thermodynamics is also used in determining the **theoretical limits for the performance** of commonly used engineering systems such as heat engines and refrigerators
- The second law can also predict the **degree of completion of chemical reactions**.





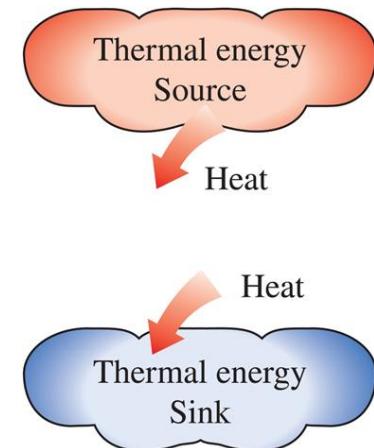
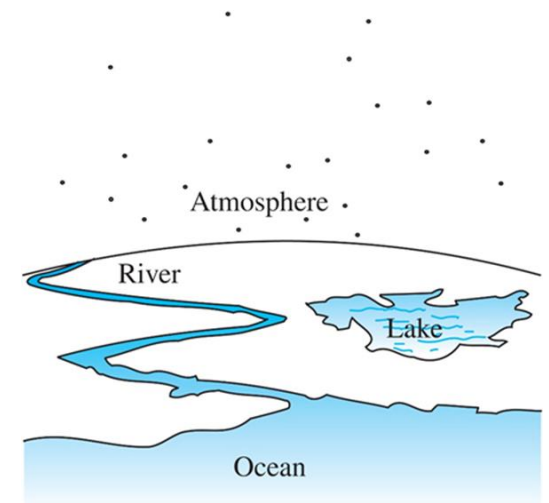
# Introduction

## Illustrations of the second law.



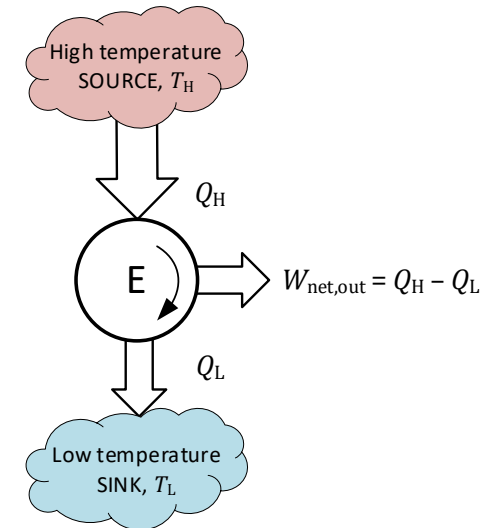
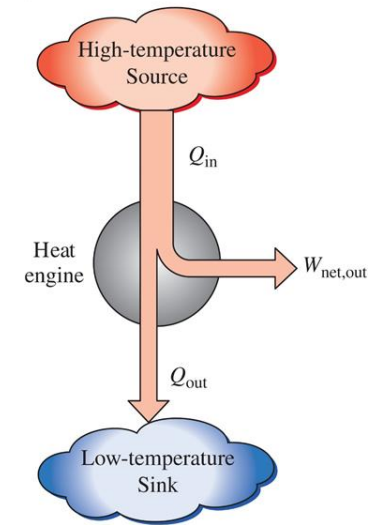
# Thermal Energy Reservoirs (Sources and Sinks)

- A **thermal energy reservoir** (or just **reservoir**) is a hypothetical body that has a **large thermal energy capacity** ( $\text{mass} \times \text{specific heat}$ )
- It can **supply or absorb finite amounts of heat** energy without undergoing any appreciable temperature change.
- Examples: the atmosphere, lakes, rivers, the ocean
- A reservoir that **supplies heat energy** is called a **source**
- A reservoir that **absorbs heat energy** is called a **sink**



# Heat Engines

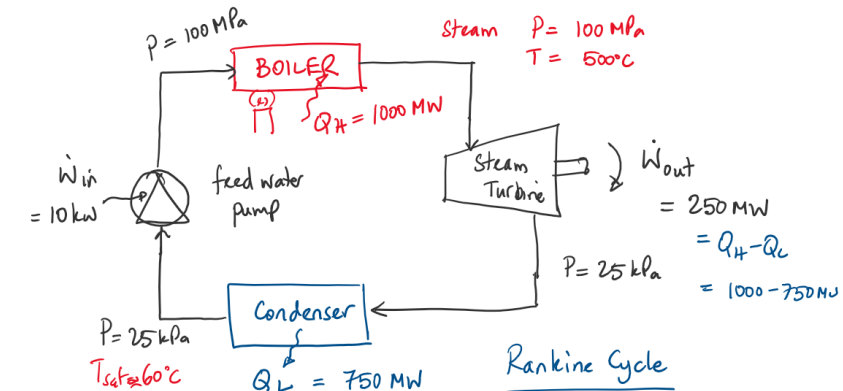
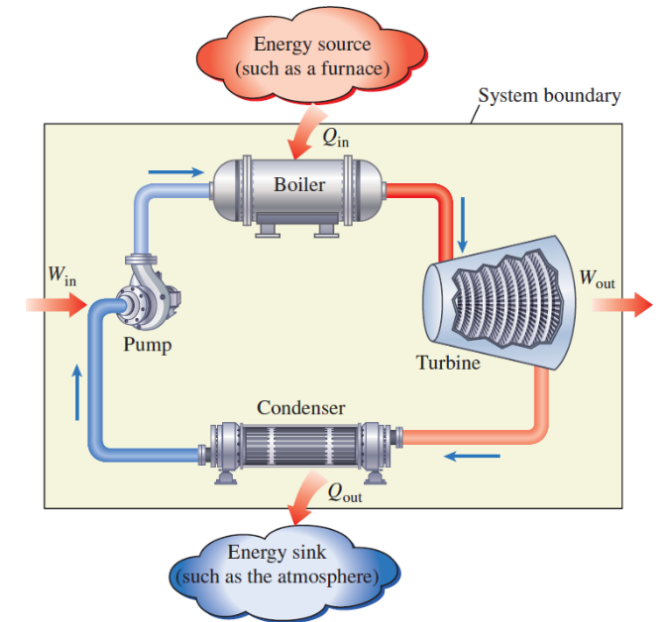
- Work can be converted directly and completely to heat (friction) but **converting heat to work requires a special device called a *heat engine***.
- Heat engines are characterised by
  - They receive heat,  $Q_H$  from a high-temperature source (at  $T_H$ ). (combustion of fuel, solar energy, nuclear reactor etc).
  - They convert part of this heat to work,  $W_{\text{net,out}}$  (e.g. rotating shaft).
  - They reject remaining waste heat,  $Q_L$  to a low-temperature sink (at  $T_L$ ). (Usually the atmosphere, lake etc).
  - They operate on a cycle.
- Heat engines and other cyclic devices usually involve a fluid called the ***working fluid***. Heat is transferred to and from the working fluid as it undergoes the cycle.
- Note:  $Q_H = Q_{\text{in}}$ ,  $Q_L = Q_{\text{out}}$  (and are all magnitudes).



# Heat Engines

## Example: Steam Power Plant (Rankine Cycle)

- Heat is supplied to the cycle ( $\dot{Q}_H$ ) via the boiler (e.g. combustion of gas in the furnace). This increases the temperature and energy of the steam (e.g. 100 MPa, 500°C)
- The high energy steam enters the turbine which converts some of that energy into shaft work ( $\dot{W}_{out}$ ) and leaves at low pressure
- The steam condenses to liquid water in the condenser by rejecting heat ( $\dot{Q}_L$ ) to the environment.
- The liquid water at low pressure from the condenser enters the feed water pump which increases the pressure (compresses) the liquid water to boiler pressure ( $\dot{W}_{in}$ ).



$$\dot{W}_{net,out} = \dot{W}_{out} - \dot{W}_{in}$$



# Heat Engines

## Thermal Efficiency

- A measure of the **performance** of a heat engine
- Generally we can define performance as:

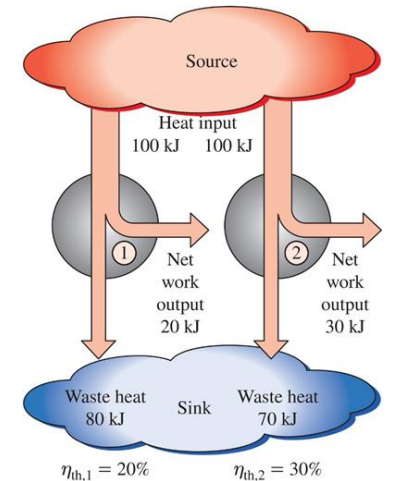
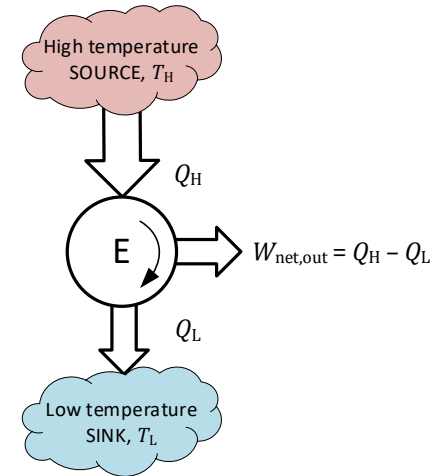
$$\text{performance} = \frac{\text{desired output}}{\text{required input}}$$

- For a heat engine the desired output is  $W_{\text{net,out}}$  and the required input is  $Q_H$ . So the thermal efficiency of a heat engine,  $\eta_{\text{th}}$  is:

$$\eta_{\text{th}} = \frac{W_{\text{net,out}}}{Q_H}$$

- And from the first law:  $W_{\text{net,out}} = Q_H - Q_L$ , so

$$\eta_{\text{th}} = \frac{Q_H - Q_L}{Q_H} = 1 - \frac{Q_L}{Q_H}$$



**Figure 7-12:** Some heat engines perform better than others (convert more of the heat they receive to work).

# Heat Engines

## Can we save $Q_L$ ( $Q_{out}$ )?

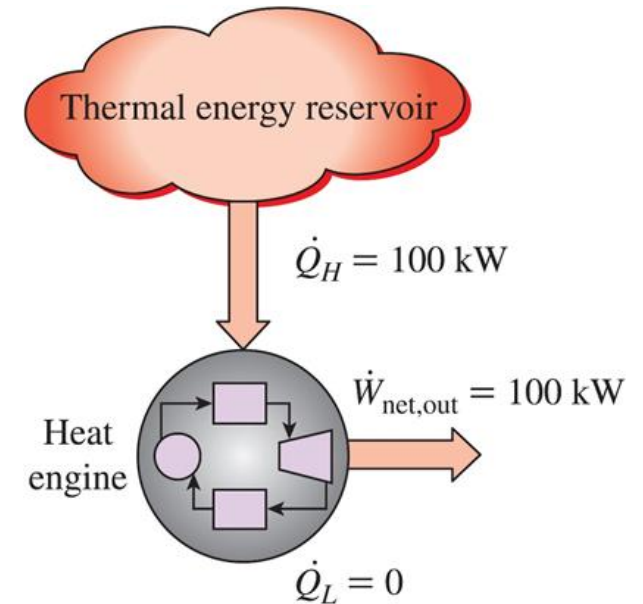
- For a heat engine to operate there **must** be some heat rejected ( $Q_L$  or  $Q_{out}$ )
- Often that is a significant amount e.g. if thermal efficiency is 40% then 60% of the heat supplied is rejected as waste heat.
- That waste heat cannot be used usefully in the current cycle however it could be used in other processes. E.g.
  - for another heat engine where it becomes the heat source.
  - Process heat for other industrial operations.

# The Kelvin-Planck Statement

- **The Kelvin-Planck statement:**

*It is impossible for any device that operates on a cycle to receive heat from a single reservoir and produce a net amount of work*

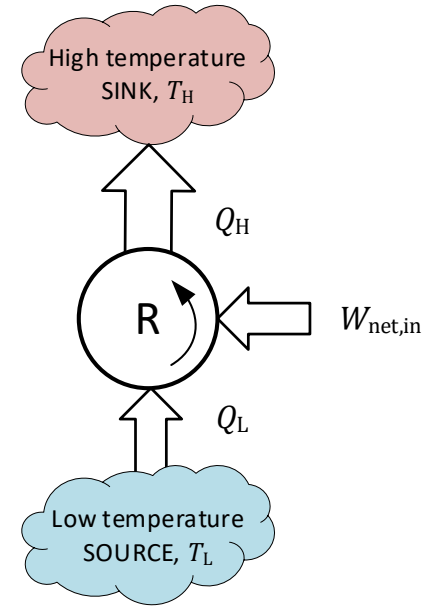
- In other words, it is impossible for  $Q_L$  to be zero and **impossible for the thermal efficiency to be 100%.**
- Or the thermal efficiency of a heat engine must be less than 100%.
- The Kelvin-Planck statement is a statement of the second law.



This is impossible.  
(Okay by the first law)

# Refrigerators and Heat Pumps

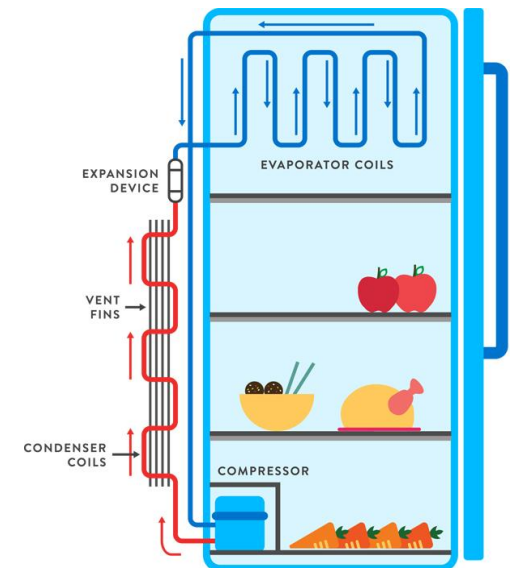
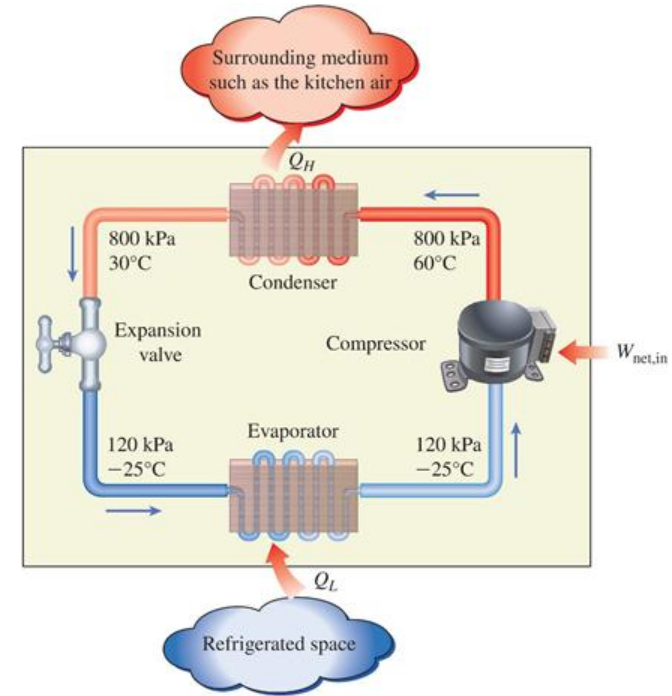
- Heat flows naturally from a high temperature (hot) to a low temperature (cold) but to cause **heat to flow from cold to hot** requires a special device, called a **refrigerator or heat pump**.
- The characteristics of a refrigerator or heat pump are:
  - Absorb heat ( $Q_L$ ) from a low temperature source (at  $T_L$ ).
  - Deliver heat ( $Q_H$ ) to a high temperature sink (at  $T_H$ ).
  - Requires energy input (usually work,  $W_{\text{net,in}} = Q_H - Q_L$ ).
  - Operates in a cycle.
- The working fluid in these cycles is called a **refrigerant**



# Refrigerators and Heat Pumps

## Example: Vapour Compression refrigeration cycle

- Refrigerant enters the compressor as a vapour and is compressed to a higher pressure ( $\dot{W}_{\text{net,in}}$ ).
- It leaves the compressor at relatively high temperature and condenses in the coils of the condenser by rejecting heat to the surroundings ( $\dot{Q}_H$ ).
- It then enters a capillary tube where, as a result of the throttling effect, its pressure and temperature drop dramatically.
- The low temperature liquid refrigerant enters the evaporator where it evaporates by absorbing heat from the refrigerated space ( $\dot{Q}_L$ ).
- The cycle is completed as the refrigerant leaves the evaporator as a vapour and re-enters the compressor.

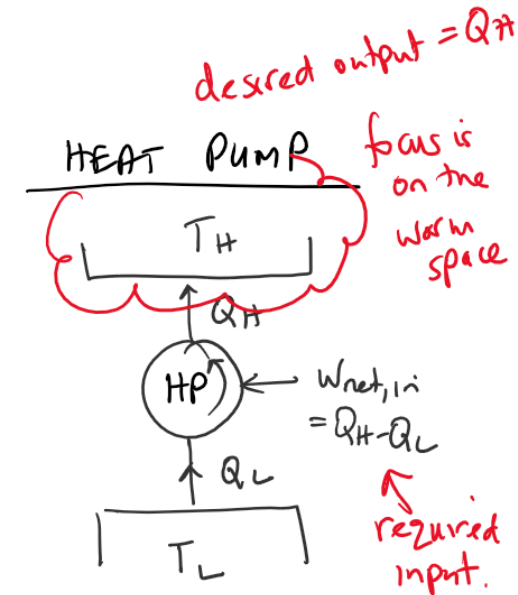
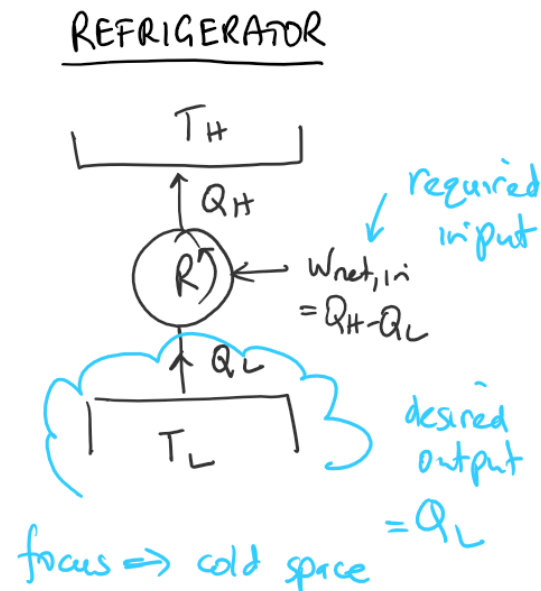




# Refrigerators and Heat Pumps

## Heat Pump vs Refrigerator, what's the difference?

- They both operate on the same cycle but the difference is in terms of **purpose**:
  - Refrigerator: **focus is on the cold space**: keeps a cool space cold, so desired output is  $Q_L$ .
  - Heat pump: **focus is on the warm space**: keeps a warm space hot, so desired output is  $Q_H$ .



# Refrigerators and Heat Pumps

The efficiency of a refrigerator or heat pump is expressed in terms of a coefficient of performance

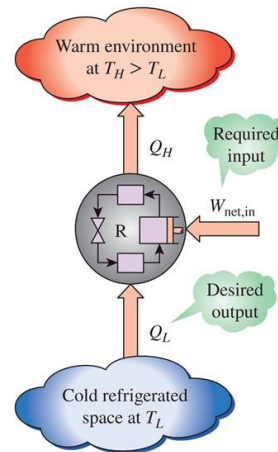
- **Refrigerator**: objective is to remove heat ( $Q_L$ ) from the refrigerated space.

$$COP_R = \frac{\text{desired output}}{\text{required input}}$$

$$\Rightarrow COP_R = \frac{Q_L}{W_{\text{net,in}}}$$

And since  $W_{\text{net,out}} = Q_H - Q_L$

$$COP_R = \frac{Q_L}{Q_H - Q_L} = \frac{1}{\frac{Q_H}{Q_L} - 1}$$



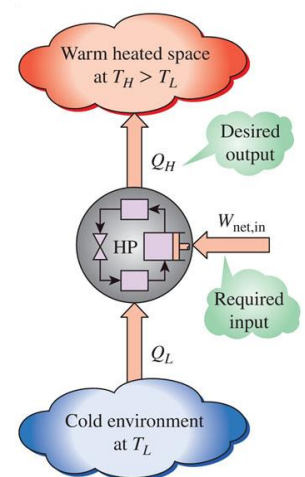
- **Heat pump**: objective is to deliver heat ( $Q_H$ ) to a warmer space.

$$COP_{HP} = \frac{\text{desired output}}{\text{required input}}$$

$$\Rightarrow COP_{HP} = \frac{Q_H}{W_{\text{net,in}}}$$

And since  $W_{\text{net,out}} = Q_H - Q_L$

$$COP_{HP} = \frac{Q_H}{Q_H - Q_L} = \frac{1}{1 - \frac{Q_L}{Q_H}}$$

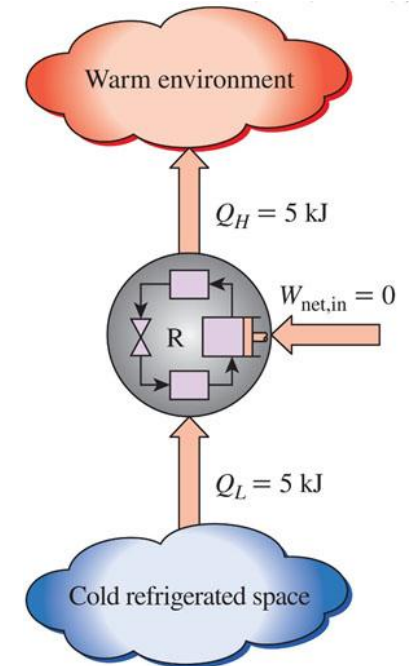


# The Clausius statement

## The Clausius Statement:

*It is impossible to construct a device that operates in a cycle and produces no effect other than transfer of heat from a lower temperature body to a higher temperature body*

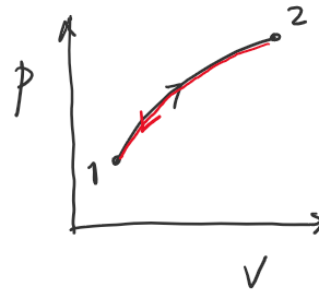
- In other words, it is impossible for a refrigerator or heat pump to operate unless there is some energy input (usually work) to drive the cycle
- It is impossible for the  $COP$  to be infinitely large (which it would be if  $W_{\text{net,in}}$  was equal to zero:  $COP_R = \frac{Q_L}{W_{\text{net,in}}}$ ).



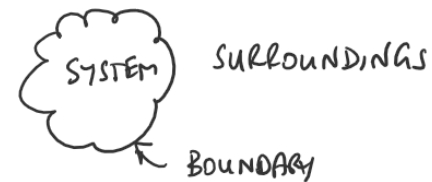
This is impossible.  
(Okay by the first law)

# Reversible and Irreversible Processes

- The second law states (Kelvin-Planck statement) that it is impossible for a heat engine to have a thermal efficiency of 100%. **So, what is the maximum possible efficiency of a heat engine?**
- To answer this question, we need to consider an **idealised process** called a **reversible process**.
- A reversible process is a process that can be **reversed with no net change to the system or surroundings**.
- **All normal, practical processes are irreversible** in that it may be possible to return the system to its original state but there would have been a net change on the surroundings.



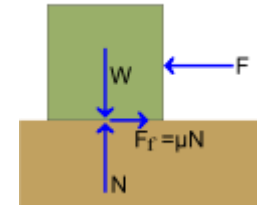
1 → 2 a process  
2 → 1 the reverse of that process



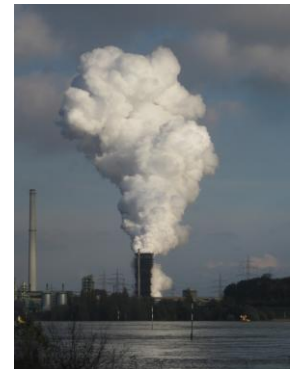
# Reversible and Irreversible Processes

## Irreversibilities

- These are factors that **cause ALL real processes to be irreversible** and they include:
  - friction
  - unrestrained expansion of gases
  - mixing of two fluids
  - heat transfer across a finite temperature difference
  - combustion, explosions
  - electric resistance
  - chemical reactions etc.
- In real, practical processes one or more of these factors will always be present.



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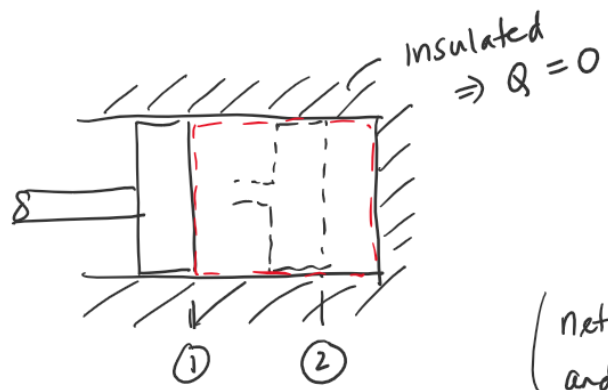




# Reversible and Irreversible Processes

## Reversible Processes

- The adiabatic compression of a gas in a cylinder comes close to being a reversible process.
- If we assume perfect insulation and frictionless operation, then it is a reversible process.
- In the practical process, friction (and heat loss) leave a net change on the surroundings and so is irreversible.

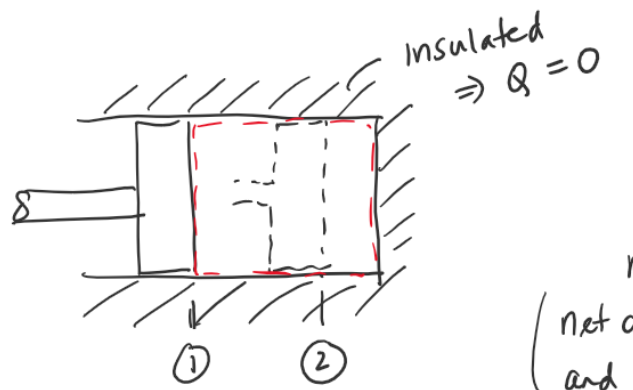


| ideal (work)                                  | practical (work)             |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| ① → ② - 8 kJ                                  | ① → ② - 9 kJ                 |
| ② → ① + 8 kJ                                  | ② → ① + 7 kJ                 |
| net work 0 kJ                                 | net change - 2 kJ            |
| (net change on system and surroundings = '0') | (on system and surroundings) |
| REVERSIBLE PROCESS                            | IRREVERSIBLE PROCESS         |

friction = 1 kJ

# Reversible and Irreversible Processes

- From this example it can be seen that reversible processes:
  - Consume the least amount of work (when the work is in)
  - Produce the maximum amount of work (when work is out)
- Therefore, a **heat engine cycle based on reversible processes should give us the maximum efficiency possible** (i.e. the theoretical limit for the thermal efficiency of a heat engine).

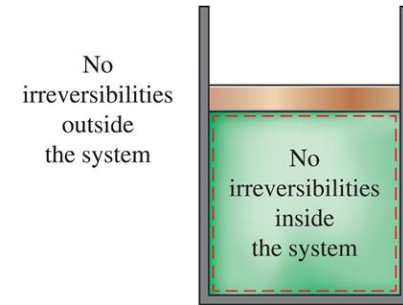


| ideal (work)                                  | practical (work)             |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| ① → ② - 8 kJ                                  | ① → ② - 9 kJ                 |
| ② → ① + 8 kJ                                  | ② → ① + 7 kJ                 |
| net work 0 kJ                                 | net change - 2 kJ            |
| (net change on system and surroundings = '0') | (on system and surroundings) |
| REVERSIBLE PROCESS                            | IRREVERSIBLE PROCESS         |

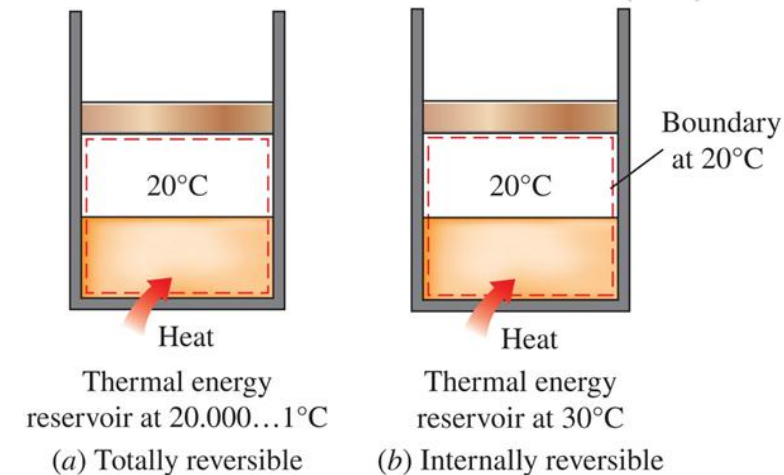
friction = 1 kJ

# Reversible and Irreversible Processes

- **Quasi-equilibrium process:** Defined as a process where the system remains infinitesimally close to the state of equilibrium at all times.
- **Internally and Externally Reversible Processes**
  - **Internally reversible process:** no irreversibilities occur to the system within the system boundary during the process. (Surroundings may have experienced some irreversibilities)
  - **Externally reversible process:** no irreversibilities occur to the surroundings during the process.
  - **Totally reversible process:** no irreversibilities occur to the system or surroundings during the process
- **For a process to be reversible there must be no irreversibilities and there must be no non-quasi-equilibrium changes.**

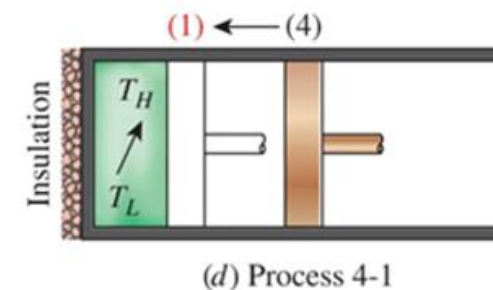
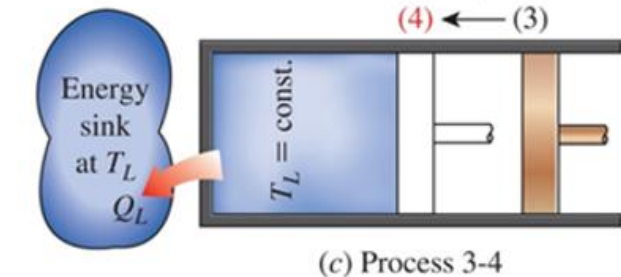
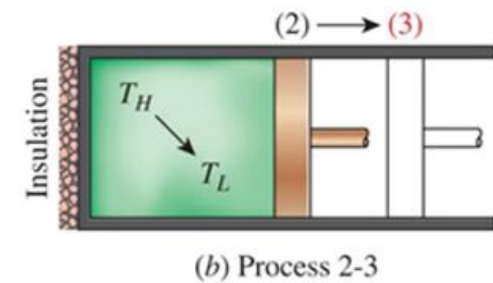
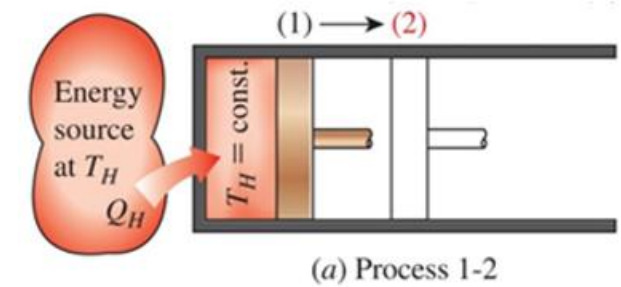


A totally reversible process



# The Carnot Cycle

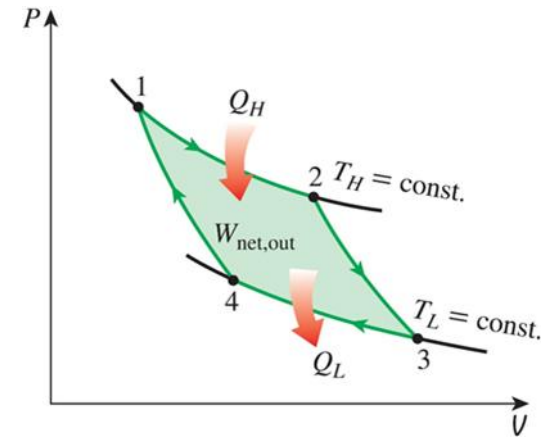
- The Carnot Cycle is a cycle based on reversible processes and is therefore **the most efficient cycle for a heat engine**.
- It is made up of four internally reversible processes:
  - 1 → 2 **frictionless isothermal absorption of heat** energy at the higher temperature,  $T_H$ . Work done, expansion process.
  - 2 → 3 **frictionless adiabatic expansion** to the lower temperature,  $T_L$ . Work done
  - 3 → 4 **frictionless isothermal rejection of heat** energy at the lower temperature,  $T_L$ . Work in, compression process
  - 4 → 1 **frictionless adiabatic compression** to the higher temperature,  $T_H$ .



# The Carnot Cycle

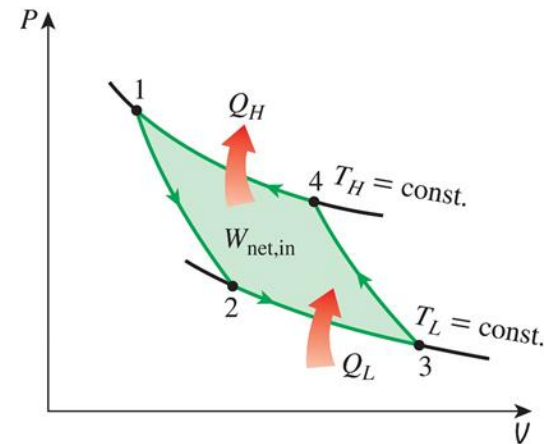
- The Carnot Cycle illustrated on a  $P - V$  diagram

- $1 \rightarrow 2$  frictionless isothermal absorption of heat energy
- $2 \rightarrow 3$  frictionless adiabatic expansion.
- $3 \rightarrow 4$  frictionless isothermal rejection of heat energy
- $4 \rightarrow 1$  frictionless adiabatic compression



Carnot Cycle

- The Carnot cycle can be reversed (reversible processes!) in which case it becomes The Carnot refrigeration cycle

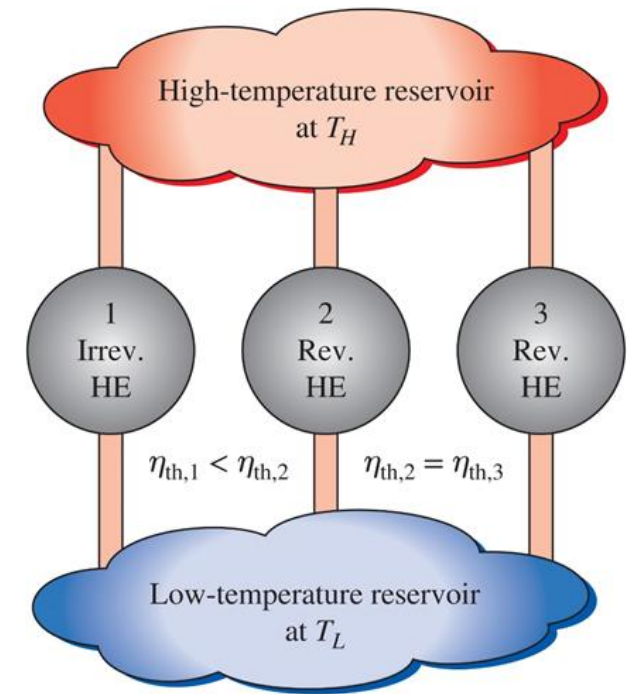


Reversed Carnot Cycle



# The Carnot Principles

- From the Kelvin-Planck and Clausius statements applied to reversible and irreversible heat engines it is possible to express the **Carnot Principles**:
  - The efficiency of an irreversible heat engine is always less than the efficiency of a reversible one operating between the same two reservoirs.
  - The efficiencies of all reversible heat engines operating between the same two reservoirs is the same.



# Carnot Heat Engine – Carnot Efficiency

- It is possible to show that for a reversible cycle

$$\left(\frac{Q_H}{Q_L}\right)_{\text{rev}} = \frac{T_H}{T_L}$$

(Where temperatures are in Kelvin)

- Now, the efficiency of *any* heat engine is

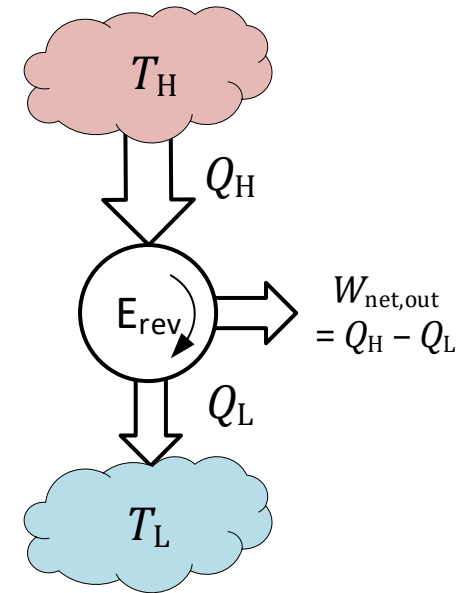
$$\eta_{\text{th}} = \frac{W_{\text{net,out}}}{Q_H} = \frac{Q_H - Q_L}{Q_H} = 1 - \frac{Q_L}{Q_H}$$

- So, the **efficiency of a Carnot or reversible heat engine is:**

$$\eta_{\text{th,rev}} = 1 - \left(\frac{Q_L}{Q_H}\right)_{\text{rev}}$$

So

$$\eta_{\text{th,rev}} = 1 - \frac{T_L}{T_H}$$



# Carnot Heat Engine – Carnot Efficiency

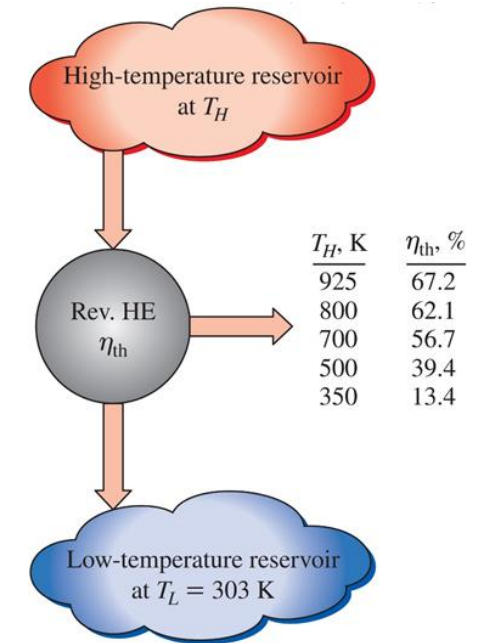
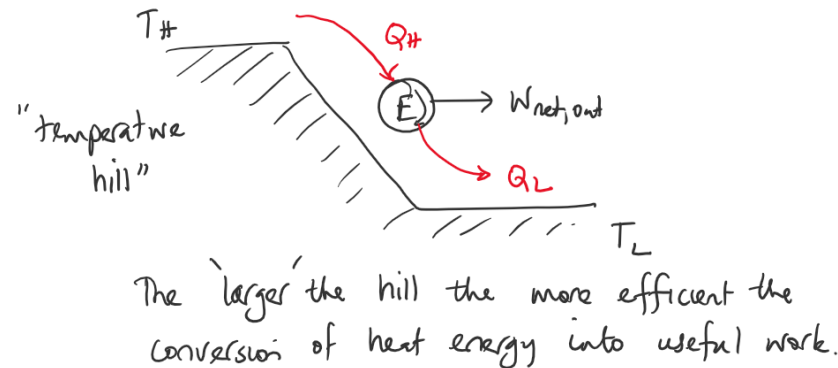
$$\eta_{\text{th,rev}} = 1 - \frac{T_L}{T_H}$$

- This is the highest possible efficiency of a heat engine operating between two thermal energy reservoirs at  $T_H$  and  $T_L$ .
- And so, to maximise this ideal efficiency the heat should be absorbed at as high a temperature as possible and should be rejected at as low a temperature as possible. This applies to practical, irreversible heat engines as well.
- Examples
- So, if  $\eta_{\text{th}}$  is the thermal efficiency of a heat engine then:

$$\eta_{\text{th}} \begin{cases} < \eta_{\text{th,rev}} & \text{irreversible (i.e. real) heat engine} \\ = \eta_{\text{th,rev}} & \text{reversible heat engine} \\ > \eta_{\text{th,rev}} & \text{impossible heat engine} \end{cases}$$

# Quality of Energy

- We see that for the Carnot efficiency, the higher the temperature of the source the greater the thermal efficiency so *as the temperature of the high-temperature source increases more of the high-temperature thermal energy can be converted to useful work.*
- Therefore: **the higher the temperature the higher the quality of the heat energy.**
- And again, **work is a more valuable form of energy transfer than heat** as 100% of work can be converted to heat but only a fraction of the heat can be converted to work.



**Figure 7-46:** The fraction of heat that can be converted to work as a function of source temperature (for  $T_L = 303 \text{ K}$ ).

# Carnot Refrigerator and Heat Pump

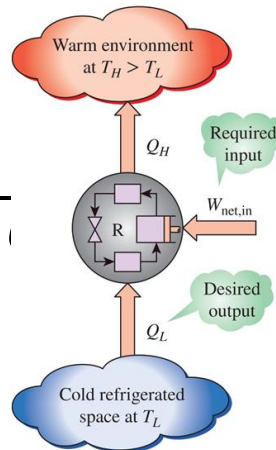
- If we consider a refrigerator or heat pump based on the reversed Carnot cycle, we can determine the **maximum possible  $COP$** .

- Refrigerator.**

For any refrigerator:

$$COP_R = \frac{Q_L}{W_{\text{net,in}}} = \frac{Q_L}{Q_H - Q_L}$$

$$COP_R = \frac{1}{\frac{Q_H}{Q_L} - 1}$$



So for a **reversible refrigerator**

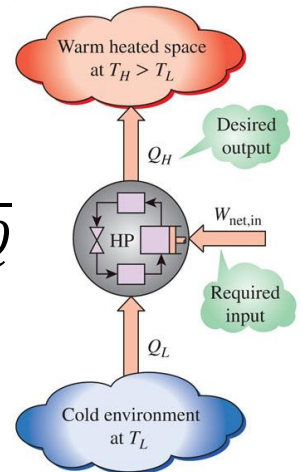
$$COP_{R,\text{rev}} = \frac{1}{\frac{T_H}{T_L} - 1}$$

- Heat pump.**

For any heat pump:

$$COP_{HP} = \frac{Q_H}{W_{\text{net,in}}} = \frac{Q_H}{Q_H - Q_L}$$

$$COP_{HP} = \frac{1}{1 - \frac{Q_L}{Q_H}}$$



So for a **reversible heat pump**

$$COP_{HP,\text{rev}} = \frac{1}{1 - \frac{T_L}{T_H}}$$



# Carnot Refrigerator and Heat Pump

$$COP_{R,rev} = \frac{1}{\frac{T_H}{T_L} - 1}$$

$$COP_{HP,rev} = \frac{1}{1 - \frac{T_L}{T_H}}$$

- These  $COP$ 's represent the highest possible for a refrigerator or heat pump operating between the temperature limits of at  $T_L$  and  $T_H$
- And so, to maximise these ideal coefficients of performance the difference between  $T_L$  and  $T_H$  should be as low as possible (a small “temperature hill”). In other words, the  $COP$  will reduce as the temperature difference increases. This applies to practical, irreversible heat engines as well.



# Carnot Refrigerator and Heat Pump

- So, if  $COP_R$  is the coefficient of performance for a refrigerator then:

$$COP_R \begin{cases} < COP_{R,rev} & \text{irreversible (i.e. real) refrigerator} \\ = COP_{R,rev} & \text{reversible refrigerator} \\ > COP_{R,rev} & \text{impossible refrigerator} \end{cases}$$

- Similarly for a heat pump:

$$COP_{HP} \begin{cases} < COP_{HP,rev} & \text{irreversible (i.e. real) heat pump} \\ = COP_{HP,rev} & \text{reversible heat pump} \\ > COP_{HP,rev} & \text{impossible heat pump} \end{cases}$$